

The timed walkthrough

Monday 21 September 2026. What you do, minute by minute, from 10:00 to 12:50.

ROOM	LENGTH	BLOCKS	STEPS	BUILT FROM
SCI L104	170 minutes	12	33	COURSE-TRUTH 08c99640c23c70d8

Two things this document will not let you get wrong. Critical Role is the cold open, 0:00 to 18:51, and you **stop at 18:51** because the ads start there. Hamilton is the sixty second trailer played three times, not Act I. Alex is working from the same clock at gordonusc.github.io/the-cabinet/ctin290-september-21/ALEX/

10:00 to 10:08 Sound and action

8 min · ASTRA

10:00 Open Astra's sound-and-action lab on the projector. Run the same action three times: sound early, sound on time, sound late. Say nothing while it plays.
3 min

10:03 Ask for a show of hands on which one felt like contact. Then ask the one that matters: what changed, the picture or the sound?
4 min

SAY: *Nothing on screen moved. The only thing that changed was when you heard it.*

10:07 Leave the lab open. You come back to this at 11:05 when Hamilton does the same trick with a cut.
1 min

10:08 to 10:10 One viewing question

2 min · ASTRA

10:08 Write the day's question on the board and leave it there for 170 minutes. Do not answer it yet.
2 min

SAY: *In a theater your eye chooses. On a screen somebody chose for you. What did that buy, and what did it cost?*

10:10 to 10:40 Critical Role, the cold open

30 min · 0:00:00 to 0:18:51 · DARBY

10:10 Open 3Mbynm0pGX0 at 0:00. Full screen. Sound up. Tell them it runs about nineteen minutes and that they are watching for one thing.

1 min

SAY: *Four hundred and fifty hours of performance, one camera that barely moves. By noon you will be able to tell these people apart with the sound off.*

10:11 Play 0:00:00 to 0:01:05. The GM asks Liam to introduce his character and Hal describes himself: an older orc, dark hair streaked white, fine but not ostentatious clothing, smile lines from a life well lived. Let it run, do not narrate over it.

2 min

10:13 Keep playing to 0:06:30. At 0:04:59 the GM turns to Luis and Azune Nayar gets the same treatment: the braid, the birthmark up the right side of the face, eyes like a sunset on an ocean.

4 min

10:17 Play on to 0:18:51 and STOP THERE. Do not go past it. At 0:18:51 the cold open ends and the show runs nine minutes of announcements and a wedding ring sponsor sketch.

17 min

10:34 Lights up. One question to the room before anyone opens a laptop. Take three answers, no more.

6 min

SAY: *They described themselves out loud, in order, before the show had a title card. What did each of them choose to tell you first?*

10:40 to 10:55 The three terms, performance labs

15 min · ASTRA

10:40 Astra's blocking lab: session-9.html#performance-lab. Wide view, camera fixed, overhead plan visible. Run Approach and Move away and let them see all three end positions.

5 min

SAY: *Blocking is position plus trajectory. Who moved last, and what did that movement tell you before anybody spoke?*

10:45 Switch to ?mode=gesture. Open palm, folded arms, three fingertip cuff touches. Half speed if the room is missing it.

5 min

SAY: *Gesturality. If you muted this, how many of these people could you still tell apart?*

10:50 Switch to ?mode=framing, frozen at 3.0 seconds. Toggle Both performers against Listener reaction. Do not restart between crops, that is the whole point.

5 min

SAY: *Reaction shot. Whose face is the story right now, and is it the person talking?*

10:55 to 11:05 Ten-minute break

10 min

10:55 The full ten, and leave the room. The back half is the half that has to land. Cue the Hamilton trailer to 0:00 while they are out so you are not scrubbing in front of them.
10 min

11:05 to 11:30 Hamilton, the trailer, three plays

25 min · 60 seconds, three times · DARBY

11:05 Play DSCKfXpAGHc once, cold, all sixty seconds. No setup, no question in advance.
2 min

11:07 Play it a second time with the sound OFF. Tell them to watch only where the cuts land and to count them on their fingers.
6 min

SAY: *You have no music and no lyrics now. Count the cuts. Somebody chose every one of those.*

11:13 Play it a third time with sound, and have the room call each cut out loud as it happens. It will be ragged for fifteen seconds and then it locks in.
8 min

11:21 Go back to 0:27 and hold it. Angelica sings To your Union and the company answers underneath her in the same bars. Two performances at once, one frame.
6 min

SAY: *In the house you decide whether to watch her or watch them. Here the edit already decided, and you cannot undo it. Name the gain first: a close-up no seat could buy. Now name the loss.*

11:27 Astra's question to close the block, from viewing-cues.html: a table, a stage, a chosen view.
3 min

11:30 to 11:38 Critical Role, a small gesture

8 min · from 0:07:28 · ASTRA

11:30 Back to 3Mbynm0pGX0 at 0:07:28. Seventy seconds this time, not nineteen minutes.
2 min

11:32 Play 7:28 to 8:38. Pause at 7:38 on Luis's hands. Run to 8:28 with Brennan speaking. Pause at 8:33 on Luis listening.
4 min

SAY: *Same three terms, one minute of tape. An hour ago you watched them establish a person. This is the same person, doing one small thing.*

11:36 Name the cost out loud: the camera did not cut, so you chose where to look. That is the opposite of what Hamilton just did to you.
2 min

11:38 to 11:50 A camera choice for a game

12 min · ASTRA

11:38 Astra's framing lab again, but turned toward their own work.

4 min

SAY: *Where do you put the lens when the performance was not staged for one?*

11:42 Take three answers and push each one: what does your choice cost the player? Write the three on the board. These become prototype notes in three weeks.

8 min

11:50 to 11:55 One World, Two Media, named

5 min · ASTRA

11:50 Open [assignment-video-essay.html](#) with the rubric visible. Due Thursday 24 September, 5:00 PM PT. Say the connection plainly, because most of them will not make it themselves.

5 min

SAY: *Hamilton on stage against Hamilton on screen is one of the four approved pairs. The argument I just ran at 11:05 is the assignment. You watched one performed.*

11:55 to 12:15 Evidence rehearsal and feedback

20 min · ASTRA

11:55 [student-notes.html](#). Each student rehearses one evidence-backed comparison with a partner: point at a frame, name the term, say what it costs.

8 min

12:03 I Like, I Wish, What If in pairs, then two share-backs to the room. Hold them to the vocabulary: the lighting is really good is not a sentence.

7 min

12:10 Name what is due and what is not. Nothing new is set tonight, and say the difference.

5 min

SAY: *No new homework. You already carry three things: the video Thursday, the mood board on the first, and the terms.*

12:15 to 12:45 MOOD BOARD TEAM TIME, team set 1

30 min · GORDON

12:15 Teams into their four groups. Put the worked examples up on the projector while they settle:
3 min gordonusc.github.io/the-cabinet/ctin290-mood-boards/

SAY: *The only in-class time this project gets. Sessions 10, 11 and 12 have no team block, so the next time we are all in a room it is your presentation.*

12:18 Team 1. Look at the board as it actually stands, not at a description of it. Then the two
7 min questions.

SAY: *Say your palette out loud. Now show me the one image you cannot justify.*

12:25 Team 2. Same two questions. Name the single most likely reason this misses Thursday 1
7 min October.

12:32 Team 3. Same. If a board is twenty beautiful photographs with no screens in it, say so now,
7 min not on 5 October.

12:39 Team 4. Same. Before you leave each team, agree one thing that will be true by Wednesday
6 min and write it down.

12:45 to 12:50 Exit ticket, two lines

5 min

12:45 Two lines on paper, collected at the door. Tell them why the second line matters.
5 min

SAY: *One term you learned today and where you saw it. One thing you are still unsure of. The second line is the one I actually need.*

Every wall-clock time on this page is calculated from the single course source, `~/usc/ctin290/COURSE-TRUTH.json`, hash `08c99640c23c70d8`, and the builder asserts that the steps inside each block add up to the block. Blocks marked ASTRA are Astra's labs and screens, kept as built. If this document and any PDF in the September 21 packet disagree, this one is current: the packet binaries were generated before Gordon's 4:05 AM ruling on the Critical Role screening.